PLAYER INSTRUCTIONS

Murder

Everything you need to set up and play this mystery game. Read this page before beginning the investigation.

PLAYERS	DURATION	DIFFICULTY	AUDIENCE
4 - 8	60 min	Medium	Adults

Setup

1

Gather Your Players

This mystery is designed for 4 - 8 players. One person should act as the Game Master and read from the Game Master Guide.

2

Distribute Character Cards

Give each player their suspect card. Study your character's background, motive and alibi carefully — you may need to defend yourself.

3

Read the Story Aloud

Have the Game Master read the Mystery Story introduction. This sets the scene and introduces the crime.

4

Begin the Investigation

Players take turns examining clues, questioning suspects, and working through puzzles. Every clue matters.

Game Rules

- **Stay in character.** You are your suspect — defend yourself, but stay truthful to what your character would know.
- **Share clues openly.** Discussion and cooperation are the fastest path to the truth.
- **No peeking at the Solution Guide.** Only the Game Master may read it, and only after the investigation concludes.
- **Ask the Game Master for hints** if you get stuck on a puzzle — but each hint costs you.
- **Time matters.** Aim to solve the case within 60 minutes.

Investigation Timeline

The following events are known to all players. Use them to cross-reference alibis.

22:00	GRAND BALLROOM	New Year's Eve gala begins. Charles gives a welcome speech and announces a special announcement later that night.
22:30	GRAND BALLROOM	Vivian and Charles have a tense conversation near the bar. Charles seems angry, Vivian tries to calm him.
22:45	GRAND BALLROOM	Marcus Reed is seen leaving the ballroom.
23:00	NEAR ELEVATOR	Elena Rodriguez is seen near the elevator, looking nervous.
23:00	KITCHEN	Chef Antonio Moretti is seen leaving the kitchen.
23:15	TOP FLOOR	A witness sees Vivian Cross leaving the top floor, looking flustered.
23:30	GRAND BALLROOM	Vivian returns to the party, visibly shaken but claims she was in the restroom. She makes sure to be seen by many guests.

00:00	GRAND BALLROOM	New Year's countdown and celebration. Charles is not present, which is noticed by some.
00:30	TOP FLOOR OFFICE	James Whitmore, Charles's son, goes to check on his father and finds the door locked. He gets a master key from the front desk and discovers the body. He alerts everyone.

How to Win

Accuse the correct suspect, state their motive, and explain how they committed the crime. Cross-reference the clues, the timeline, and each suspect's alibi. The Game Master will confirm whether you identified the culprit.

The case is solved when the correct culprit is named and their full method is described. Good luck, detective.